

CAREER PATHS

Gaining qualifications and membership of a professional body are useful for working as a plumber, and are essential for gas installation. Domestic plumbing is the most common area of work, but there are several options for specialization.

APPRENTICE

You can enter plumbing straight from high school as an apprentice, training on the job and learning from colleagues.



GRADUATE

Although a degree isn't required, finishing technical school or college programs may make it easier for you to secure an apprenticeship.



PLUMBER As a plumber, you will stay up to date with safety standards and technological advances throughout your career. Once you have built a good reputation, you can set up and run your own business for domestic customers.



SKILLS GUIDE



The ability to communicate effectively with both customers and colleagues.



Good interpretative and analytical skills for following technical drawings and building plans.



Confidence in using hand-held tools, including power tools and monitoring devices.



Physical stamina and the ability to work in confined spaces, such as attics and ventilation shafts.



Attention to detail, especially when working with gas and oil due to fire risks.

HEATING ENGINEER

Specializes in the design, installation, and commissioning of a wide variety of heating systems, such as oil, gas, or electrical systems.



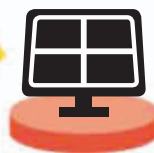
GAS SERVICE TECHNICIAN Installs, repairs, and services gas appliances and systems such as stoves, water-heaters, and gas fireplaces.



INDUSTRIAL PLUMBER Works on major plumbing projects at factories, hospitals, and offices to ensure heating, water, and drainage systems are running efficiently.



PLUMBING ESTIMATOR Assesses the scope of new plumbing projects and estimates the cost of labor and fittings. This is usually a senior role within a large plumbing firm.



RENEWABLE ENERGY ENGINEER Designs, installs, and maintains eco-friendly domestic and industrial systems, such as solar panels or biomass heating systems, which use organic fuels rather than gas, oil, or electricity.